Department of Health and Human Services

Part 1. Overview Information

Participating Organization(s)

National Institutes of Health (NIH (http://www.nih.gov))

Components of Participating Organizations

National Institute of Allergy and Infectious Diseases (NIAID (https://www.niaid.nih.gov/))

Funding Opportunity Title

Tuberculosis Research Units (P01 Clinical Trial Optional)

Activity Code

P01 (//grants.nih.gov/grants/funding/ac_search_results.htm?text_curr=p01&Search.x=0&Search.y=0&Search_Type=Activity) Research Program Projects

Announcement Type

Reissue of RFA-AI-20-020 (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/rfa-files/RFA-AI-20-020.html)

Related Notices

- **April 4, 2024** - Overview of Grant Application and Review Changes for Due Dates on or after January 25, 2025. See Notice NOT-OD-24-084 (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/notice-files/NOT-OD-24-084.html).
- **August 31, 2022**- Implementation Changes for Genomic Data Sharing Plans Included with Applications Due on or after January 25, 2023. See Notice NOT-OD-22-198 (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/notice-files/not-od-22-198.html).
- **August 5, 2022**- Implementation Details for the NIH Data Management and Sharing Policy. See Notice NOT-OD-22-189 (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/notice-files/NOT-OD-22-189.html).

Funding Opportunity Number (FON)

RFA-AI-25-027

Companion Notice of Funding Opportunity

None

Number of Applications

See Section III. 3. Additional Information on Eligibility.

Assistance Listing Number(s)

93.855

Notice of Funding Opportunity Purpose

The purpose of this notice of funding opportunity (NOFO) is to support the establishment of multidisciplinary Tuberculosis (TB) Research Units (TBRUs) that will operate as a collaborative network to improve understanding of *Mycobacterium tuberculosis* (Mtb)-host interactions through characterizing the roles of bacterial and host heterogeneity on infection outcomes and disease progression, and defining bacterial and host determinants relevant to Mtb establishment, dissemination, and disease stage.

Funding Opportunity Goal(s)

To assist public and private nonprofit institutions and individuals to establish, expand and improve biomedical research and research training in infectious diseases and related areas; to conduct developmental research, to produce and test research materials. To assist public, private and commercial institutions to conduct developmental research, to produce and test research materials, to provide research services as required by the agency for programs in infectious diseases, and controlling disease caused by infectious or parasitic agents, allergic and immunologic diseases and related areas. Projects range from studies of microbial physiology and antigenic structure to collaborative trials of experimental

drugs and vaccines, mechanisms of resistance to antibiotics as well as research dealing with epidemiological observations in hospitalized patients or community populations and progress in allergic and immunologic diseases. Because of this dual focus, the program encompasses both basic research and clinical research.

Key Dates

Posted Date

August 26, 2025

Open Date (Earliest Submission Date)

October 07, 2025

Letter of Intent Due Date(s)

30 days prior to application due date

Application Due Dates			Review and Award Cycles		
New	Renewal / Resubmission / Revision (as allowed)	AIDS - New/Renewal/Resubmission/Revision, as allowed	Scientific Merit Review	Advisory Council Review	Earliest Start Date
November 07, 2025	November 07, 2025	Not Applicable	March 2026	May 2026	July 2026

All applications are due by 5:00 PM local time of applicant organization.

Applicants are encouraged to apply early to allow adequate time to make any corrections to errors found in the application during the submission process by the due date.

Expiration Date

November 08, 2025

Due Dates for E.O. 12372

Not Applicable

Required Application Instructions

It is critical that applicants follow the Multi-Project (M) Instructions in the How to Apply - Application Guide (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82400), except where instructed to do otherwise (in this NOFO or in a Notice from the NIH Guide for Grants and Contracts (//grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=11164)). Conformance to all requirements (both in the How to Apply - Application Guide (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82400) and the NOFO) is required and strictly enforced. Applicants must read and follow all application instructions in the How to Apply - Application Guide (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82400) as well as any program-specific instructions noted in Section IV. When the program-specific instructions deviate from those in the How to Apply - Application Guide (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82400), follow the program-specific instructions. **Applications that do not comply with these instructions may be delayed or not accepted for review.**

There are several options available to submit your application through Grants.gov to NIH and Department of Health and Human Services partners. You **must** use one of these submission options to access the application forms for this opportunity.

1. Use the NIH ASSIST system to prepare, submit and track your application online.

   Apply Online Using ASSIST

2. Use an institutional system-to-system (S2S) solution to prepare and submit your application to Grants.gov and eRA Commons (https://public.era.nih.gov/commons/) to track your application. Check with your institutional officials regarding availability.

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Part 2. Full Text of Announcement

Section I. Notice of Funding Opportunity Description

Purpose

The purpose of this notice of funding opportunity (NOFO) is to support the establishment of multidisciplinary Tuberculosis (TB) Research Units (TBRUs) that will operate as a collaborative network to improve understanding of *Mycobacterium tuberculosis* (Mtb)-host interactions through characterizing the roles of bacterial and host heterogeneity on infection outcomes and disease progression and defining bacterial and host determinants relevant to Mtb establishment, dissemination, and disease stage.

Background

TB is the leading cause of death from an infectious disease, having killed 1.25 million individuals in 2023. TB incidence rates in the United States are currently the highest in over a decade, with ~9,600 US TB cases in 2023 (a 15 percent increase over 2022 case numbers), including ~340 pediatric cases. An estimated 13 million Americans live with latent TB and have a lifelong risk of developing TB disease, as triggered by poor nutrition, diabetes, aging, and immunosuppressive medications. Recent outbreaks of TB (including drug-resistant TB) in the American South, Midwest, and Pacific Northwest further highlight the need for continuing investments in understanding the factors that allow this chronic disease to persist and spread.

TB is caused by aerogenic transmission of the pathogen *Mycobacterium tuberculosis* (Mtb), which primarily infects the lung but can disseminate to extrapulmonary tissues. Improved socioeconomic conditions, public health practices, and the use of effective drug treatment have reduced TB exposure and disease rates; however, global TB incidence remains stubbornly high, and—given the ubiquity of international travel—the persistence of drug resistant Mtb strains anywhere threatens every country's ability to control TB, including the US. Globally, an estimated 400,000 new TB cases were drug resistant. The HIV pandemic has further hampered TB control efforts, as people living with HIV are more likely to develop active TB and to relapse following chemotherapy, relative to those living without HIV. For these reasons, it is important to continue research into understanding the bacterial and host determinants that affect TB infection and disease progression in people living with and without HIV.

The National Institute of Allergy and Infectious Diseases (NIAID) has made significant investments into basic, translational, and clinical research on TB, as detailed in the updated 2024 NIAID Strategic Plan for Tuberculosis Research (https://www.niaid.nih.gov/sites/default/files/tb-strategic-plan-2024.pdf) The research proposed in the TBRU program aligns with Strategic Priority 1: Improve Fundamental Knowledge of TB which includes an enhanced understanding of the pathogen Mtb to improve options for intervention, characterize host factors that contribute to TB progression and pathology, and improve and develop animal and non-animal models of TB disease.

Heterogeneity at both pathogen and host levels influence the outcome of Mtb infection and progression to disease. At the pathogen level, there are differences in strain or lineage fitness, virulence, drug resistance, cell wall composition, ability to disseminate, and survive within an aerosol. At the host level, there are differences in risk of infection and progression to disease, as influenced by lung function, immune profile, HIV status, and numerous comorbidities. Historically, TB had been categorized as either "active" or "latent" based on the presence or absence of symptoms, respectively, with active TB considered infectious and latent TB considered non-infectious. A growing body of literature suggests, however, that TB is not bimodal but includes one or more "subclinical" states which may be infectious, analogous to other respiratory pathogens which can cause asymptomatic infections yet remain contagious (e.g., Streptococcus pneumoniae). Very little is known regarding the pathophysiology of subclinical TB. Although we cannot control pathogen or host heterogeneity, by understanding their breadth and contributions to infection outcomes we can apply this knowledge to improve TB diagnostics, management, and treatment for greater numbers of people living with and without HIV.

Each TBRU will be established as part of a multi-disciplinary network of investigators and institutions with expertise in basic, pre-clinical and clinical research disciplines. Each TBRU will be overseen by a Program Director(s)/Principal Investigator(s) (PD(s)/PI(s)) who will coordinate and oversee its multidisciplinary research and ensure that the individual research projects synergize to advance the goals of this NOFO to characterize bacterial and host determinants that are relevant during stages of infection, disease, and transmission, as well as the impact of bacterial and host heterogeneity on disease outcomes. Investigators are encouraged to develop pathogen specific tools and incorporate emerging technologies. To facilitate the understanding of the spectrum of TB infection and disease and enable the translation of research findings into clinical applications, each TBRU must include a minimum of two interdependent Research Projects that include animal research studies and clinical research studies. This combination may help facilitate the development of more predictive, targeted, and interpretable animal models through back-translation of clinical findings. NIH-supported science should be replicable, reproducible and generalizable.

Examples of potential research areas include, but are not limited to:

- Pathophysiology and in-depth analysis of subclinical (asymptomatic) TB
- Understanding Mtb-host interactions and the effect of mycobacterial and host heterogeneity (individual and population levels) on TB outcome
- Metabolic adaptations of Mtb inside the host (persistence, resistance)
- Development of animal models that reflect human pathogenesis and development of applicable ex vivo systems to reduce the use of animals in research
- The role of comorbidities and/or coinfections on TB and treatment outcomes
- Studies to better understand the role of HIV on TB disease progression
- Tools for TB research

Applications proposing the following topics will be considered non-responsive and will not be reviewed:

- Applications that do not include both clinical and animal research studies
- Immune correlates of protection studies and analysis of immune responses to vaccine candidates
- Impact of substance abuse (e.g. opioids, cannabinoids, cocaine, methamphetamines, and alcohol) on TB transmission, progression and disease
- Research with a primary focus on epidemiologic studies
- Psychosocial or behavioral research

Please note that it is expected that some animal models that are developed by the TBRUs will be suitable for product development and evaluation. NIAID may request transfer of the protocols for these animal models to the NIAID Division of Microbiology and Infectious Diseases (DMID) preclinical services programs to be made available as a service to the community.

TBRU Program Structure

Administrative Core
Each TBRU must include an Administrative Core which is responsible for managing, coordinating, and supervising all TBRU activities. The Administrative Core should include a Management Plan that will guide its operations and describe how data will be shared internally between projects and cores during the award.

Scientific Core(s)
At least one Scientific Core is required as a resource for the entire TBRU, but up to four Scientific Cores are allowed if scientifically justified. Each shared Scientific Core must be utilized by two or more Research Projects within the TBRU. Research activities should only be conducted in the Research Projects; Scientific Cores perform services and tasks, not research activities. Examples of services provided include, but are not limited to reagent production, specialized services (e.g. assays, “omics”, imaging, statistics, bioinformatics), animal core, or a clinically focused core.

Research Projects Each TRBU must include a minimum of two (maximum of four) interdependent Research Projects to meet the NOFO’s key goals of supporting cross disciplinary TB research engaging both clinical and animal model researchers. At least one Research Project must involve animal model studies, and at least one Research Project must involve clinical studies. Alternatively, this requirement can also be met by proposing Research Projects that include both animal model studies and clinical studies, provided they are related through a common research hypothesis.

For the purposes of this NOFO, clinical studies are defined as research using new or stored material and/or data of human origin (e.g. tissues, specimens, sequences, physiological measures) that are relevant to the research hypothesis. If a clinical site(s) is part of either a Research Project or a Scientific Core, it must be present in a community where TB is prevalent or where TB is treated, and have an established infrastructure, including experienced local investigators capable of conducting human studies that meet US regulatory requirements for the protection of human subjects, adequate laboratory facilities and personnel to perform protocol-specific tests, access to patient populations that are suitable to study bacterial and host factors, as well as their relation to TB disease presentation and HIV status. Research Projects may propose using experimental or licensed drugs and interventions to establish or test hypotheses.

External Scientific Advisory Group (ESAG): Each TBRU is strongly encouraged to form an ESAG, at the discretion of the PD(s)/PI(s), after award to evaluate and advise the PD(s)/PI(s) on scientific progress. Applicants should not name, recruit or contact potential ESAG members prior to award.

Programmatic Meetings: The PD/PI will organize an annual 1 to 2-day internal TBRU meeting at the PD/PI’s institution and will extend an invitation to the NIAID Program Official.
Investigators proposing NIH-defined clinical trials may refer to the Research Methods Resources website for information about developing statistical methods and study designs.

See Section VIII. Other Information for award authorities and regulations.

Section II. Award Information

Funding Instrument

Grant: A financial assistance mechanism providing money, property, or both to an eligible entity to carry out an approved project or activity.

Application Types Allowed

New
Renewal - Renewals of RFA-AI-20-020 (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/rfa-files/rfa-ai-20-020.html)

The OER Glossary (//grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=11116) and the How to Apply - Application Guide (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82400) provides details on these application types. Only those application types listed here are allowed for this NOFO.

Clinical Trial?

Optional: Accepting applications that either propose or do not propose clinical trial(s).

Need help determining whether you are doing a clinical trial? (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82370)

Funds Available and Anticipated Number of Awards

NIAID intends to commit $10 million in FY 2026 to fund 4-5 awards.

Award Budget

Application budgets are not expected to exceed $1.5 million direct costs per year and should reflect the actual needs of the project.

Award Project Period

The scope of the proposed project should determine the project period. The maximum project period is five years.

NIH grants policies as described in the NIH Grants Policy Statement (//grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=11120) will apply to the applications submitted and awards made from this NOFO.

Section III. Eligibility Information

1. Eligible Applicants

Eligible Organizations

Higher Education Institutions - Includes all types

- Public/State Controlled Institutions of Higher Education
- Private Institutions of Higher Education

Nonprofits Other Than Institutions of Higher Education

- Nonprofits with 501(c)(3) IRS Status (Other than Institutions of Higher Education)
- Nonprofits without 501(c)(3) IRS Status (Other than Institutions of Higher Education)

For-Profit Organizations

- Small Businesses
- For-Profit Organizations (Other than Small Businesses)

Local Governments

- State Governments
- County Governments
- City or Township Governments
- Special District Governments
- Indian/Native American Tribal Governments (Federally Recognized)
- Indian/Native American Tribal Governments (Other than Federally Recognized)

Federal Governments

- Eligible Agencies of the Federal Government
- U.S. Territory or Possession

Other

- Independent School Districts
- Public Housing Authorities/Indian Housing Authorities
- Native American Tribal Organizations (other than Federally recognized tribal governments)
- Faith-based or Community-based Organizations
- Regional Organizations
- Non-domestic (non-U.S.) Entities (Foreign Organizations)

Foreign Organizations/ International Collaborations

NIH will no longer issue awards (new, renewal, or non-competing continuation) to domestic or foreign entities that involve foreign subawards/subcontracts. All NIH-funded research involving foreign subawards/subcontracts must be submitted in response to a NOFO that is specifically designated for funded international collaborations. This new requirement was effective, May 1, 2025.

Applications involving foreign subawards/subcontracts submitted in response to this NOFO will be deemed noncompliant and will not be considered for funding. This policy applies to all monetary international collaborations resulting in foreign subawards/subcontracts, however, it does not preclude unfunded international collaborations or foreign components (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/policy/nihgps/HTML5/section_1/1.2_definition_of_terms.htm), funding for foreign consultants, or procurement of unique equipment or supplies from foreign vendors.

Foreign Organizations

Non-domestic (non-U.S.) Entities (Foreign Organizations) **are** eligible to apply.

Non-domestic (non-U.S.) components of U.S. Organizations **are** eligible to apply.

Foreign components, as defined in the NIH Grants Policy Statement (//grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=11118), **are** allowed.

Required Registrations

Applicant organizations

Applicant organizations must complete and maintain the following registrations as described in the How to Apply- Application Guide (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82400) to be eligible to apply for or receive an award. All registrations must be completed prior to the application being submitted. Registration can take 6 weeks or more, so applicants should begin the registration process as soon as possible. Failure to complete registrations in advance of a due date is not a valid reason for a late submission, please reference NIH Grants Policy Statement Section 2.3.9.2 Electronically Submitted Applications (//grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82423) for additional information.

- System for Award Management (SAM) (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82390) – Applicants must complete and maintain an active registration, **which requires renewal at least annually**. The renewal process may require as much time as the initial registration. SAM registration includes the assignment of a Commercial and Government Entity (CAGE) Code for domestic organizations which have not already been assigned a CAGE Code.
    - NATO Commercial and Government Entity (NCAGE) Code (//grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=11176) – Foreign organizations must obtain an NCAGE code (in lieu of a CAGE code) in order to register in SAM.
    - Unique Entity Identifier (UEI) - A UEI is issued as part of the SAM.gov registration process. The same UEI must be used for all registrations, as well as on the grant application.
- eRA Commons (https://era.nih.gov/) - Once the unique organization identifier is established, organizations can register with eRA Commons in tandem with completing their Grants.gov registration; all registrations must be in place by time of submission. eRA Commons requires organizations to identify at least one Signing Official (SO) and at least one Program Director/Principal Investigator (PD/PI) account in order to submit an application.
- Grants.gov (//grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82300) – Applicants must have an active SAM registration in order to complete the Grants.gov registration.

Program Directors/Principal Investigators (PD(s)/PI(s))

All PD(s)/PI(s) must have an eRA Commons account. PD(s)/PI(s) should work with their organizational officials to either create a new account or to affiliate their existing account with the applicant organization in eRA Commons. If the PD/PI is also the organizational Signing Official, they must have two distinct eRA Commons accounts, one for each role. Obtaining an eRA Commons account can take up to 2 weeks.

Eligible Individuals (Program Director/Principal Investigator)

Any individual(s) with the skills, knowledge, and resources necessary to carry out the proposed research as the Program Director(s)/Principal Investigator(s) (PD(s)/PI(s)) is invited to work with his/her organization to develop an application for support.

For institutions/organizations proposing multiple PDs/PIs, visit the Multiple Program Director/Principal Investigator Policy and submission details in the Senior/Key Person Profile (Expanded) Component of the How to Apply - Application Guide (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82400).

2. Cost Sharing

This NOFO does not require cost sharing as defined in the NIH Grants Policy Statement (//grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=11126) Section 1.2- Definitions of Terms. (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/policy/nihgps/HTML5/section_1/1.2_definition_of_terms.htm)

3. Additional Information on Eligibility

Number of Applications

Applicant organizations may submit more than one application, provided that each application is scientifically distinct.

The NIH will not accept duplicate or highly overlapping applications under review at the same time per NIH Grants Policy Statement Section 2.3.7.4 Submission of Resubmission Application (//grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82415). This means that the NIH will not accept:

- A new (A0) application that is submitted before issuance of the summary statement from the review of an overlapping new (A0) or resubmission (A1) application.
- A resubmission (A1) application that is submitted before issuance of the summary statement from the review of the previous new (A0) application.

- An application that has substantial overlap with another application pending appeal of initial peer review (see NIH Grants Policy Statement 2.3.9.4 Similar, Essentially Identical, or Identical Applications (//grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82423)).

Section IV. Application and Submission Information

1. Requesting an Application Package

The application forms package specific to this opportunity must be accessed through ASSIST or an institutional system-to-system solution. A button to apply using ASSIST is available in Part 1 of this NOFO. See the administrative office for instructions if planning to use an institutional system-to-system solution.

2. Content and Form of Application Submission

It is critical that applicants follow the Multi-Project (M) Instructions in the How to Apply - Application Guide (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82400), except where instructed in this notice of funding opportunity to do otherwise and where instructions in the How to Apply - Application Guide (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82400) are directly related to the Grants.gov downloadable forms currently used with most NIH opportunities. Conformance to the requirements in the How to Apply - Application Guide (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82400) is required and strictly enforced. Applications that are out of compliance with these instructions may be delayed or not accepted for review.

Letter of Intent

Although a letter of intent is not required, is not binding, and does not enter into the review of a subsequent application, the information that it contains allows IC staff to estimate the potential review workload and plan the review.

By the date listed in Part 1. Overview Information, prospective applicants are asked to submit a letter of intent that includes the following information:

- Descriptive title of proposed activity
- Name(s), address(es), and telephone number(s) of the PD(s)/PI(s)
- Names of other key personnel
- Participating institution(s)
- Number and title of this funding opportunity

The letter of intent should be sent to:

Center for Scientific Review
Email: letterofintent@csr.nih.gov (mailto:letterofintent@csr.nih.gov)

Page Limitations

All page limitations described in the How to Apply- Application Guide (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/how-to-apply-application-guide.html) and the Table of Page Limits (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=61134) must be followed.

Component	Component Type for Submission	Page Limit	Required/Optional	Minimum	Maximum
Overall	Overall	12	Required	1	1
Admin Core	Admin Core	6	Required	1	1
Scientific Core(s)	Core	6	Required	1	4
Research Projects	Project	12	Required	2	4

Instructions for the Submission of Multi-Component Applications

The following section supplements the instructions found in How to Apply- Application Guide (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/how-to-apply-application-guide.html)and should be used for preparing a multi-component application.

The application should consist of the following components:

- Overall: required, 1
- Administrative Core: required, 1
- Scientific Core(s): required, minimum 1, maximum 4, each Core must support at least two Research Projects
- Research Projects: required, minimum 2, maximum 4

Overall Component

When preparing the application, use Component Type 'Overall'.

All instructions in the How to Apply - Application Guide (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82400) must be followed, with the following additional instructions, as noted.

SF424(R&R) Cover (Overall)

Complete entire form.

PHS 398 Cover Page Supplement (Overall)

Note: Human Embryonic Stem Cell lines from other components should be repeated in cell line table in Overall component.

Research & Related Other Project Information (Overall)

Follow standard instructions.

Project/Performance Site Locations (Overall)

Enter primary site only.

A summary of Project/Performance Sites in the Overall section of the assembled application image in eRA Commons compiled from data collected in the other components will be generated upon submission.

Research and Related Senior/Key Person Profile (Overall)

Include only the Project Director/Principal Investigator (PD/PI) and any multi-PDs/PIs (if applicable to this NOFO) for the entire application.

A summary of Senior/Key Persons followed by their Biographical Sketches in the Overall section of the assembled application image in eRA Commons will be generated upon submission.

Budget (Overall)

The only budget information included in the Overall component is the Estimated Project Funding section of the SF424 (R&R) Cover.

A budget summary in the Overall section of the assembled application image in eRA Commons compiled from detailed budget data collected in the other components will be generated upon submission.

PHS 398 Research Plan (Overall)

Specific Aims: List in priority order, the broad, overarching, long-range objectives and goals of the proposed TBRU. Concisely describe the hypothesis or hypotheses to be tested.

Research Strategy: This section summarizes the overall research strategy for the proposed TBRU. A multi-component, multidisciplinary application should be viewed as a confederation of interrelated Research Projects and Cores, each capable of standing on its own scientific merit, but complementary to one another. This is an important section and should provide the conceptual rationale of the TBRU and lay out a broad strategy for accomplishing the stated goals.

- Summarize the overarching theme of the proposed TBRU, the significance of the theme in addressing research areas important for combating TB, the scientific challenges and opportunities being addressed, and the benefit of a successful effort.
- Describe how the proposed TBRU incorporates a multidisciplinary yet interconnected set of research activities to achieve the TBRU goals and provide a compelling argument for the team-research approach.
- Describe how the individual Research Projects and Scientific Core(s) relate to the overall goals of the TBRU and form a cohesive, synergistic whole that is more beneficial than pursuing each project independently.
- We encourage including a visual/graphic representation of the interactions between the various Research Projects and Scientific Core(s) and their place in the overall TBRU delineating the collaborative and synergistic potential of the proposed TBRU.
- Without duplicating information in the Senior/Key Person Profile section, describe how the scientific and technical expertise of the research team and organization will interact to effectively design and conduct the proposed activities.

Letters of Support: Include letters of support, if applicable.

Resource Sharing Plan:
Individuals are required to comply with the instructions for the Resource Sharing Plans as provided in the How to Apply - Application Guide (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82400).

Other Plan(s):

All instructions in the How to Apply- Application Guide (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/how-to-apply-application-guide.html) must be followed, with the following additional instructions:

- All applicants planning research (funded or conducted in whole or in part by NIH) that results in the generation of scientific data are required to comply with the instructions for the Data Management and Sharing Plan. All applications, regardless of the amount of direct costs requested for any one year, must address a Data Management and Sharing Plan.

Appendix:

Only limited items are allowed in the Appendix. Follow all instructions for the Appendix as described in How to Apply- Application Guide (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/how-to-apply-application-guide.html); any instructions provided here are in addition to the How to Apply - Application Guide (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82400) instructions.

PHS Human Subjects and Clinical Trials Information (Overall)

When involving human subjects research, clinical research, and/or NIH-defined clinical trials follow all instructions for the PHS Human Subjects and Clinical Trials Information form in the How to Apply - Application Guide (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82400), with the following additional instructions:

If you answered “Yes” to the question “Are Human Subjects Involved?” on the R&R Other Project Information form, there must be at least one human subjects study record using the **Study Record: PHS Human Subjects and Clinical Trials Information** form or a **Delayed Onset Study** record within the application. The study record(s) must be included in the component(s) where the work is being done, unless the same study spans multiple components. To avoid the creation of duplicate study records, a single study record with sufficient information for all involved components must be included in the Overall component when the same study spans multiple components.

Study Record: PHS Human Subjects and Clinical Trials Information

All instructions in the How to Apply - Application Guide (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82400) must be followed.

Delayed Onset Study

Note: Delayed onset (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/glossary.htm#DelayedOnsetStudy) does NOT apply to a study that can be described but will not start immediately (i.e., delayed start). All instructions in the How to Apply- Application Guide (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82400) must be followed.

PHS Assignment Request Form (Overall)

All instructions in the How to Apply- Application Guide (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82400)must be followed.

Administrative Core

When preparing your application, use Component Type 'Admin Core.'

All instructions in the How to Apply- Application Guide (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82400)must be followed, with the following additional instructions, as noted.

SF424 (R&R) Cover (Administrative Core)

Complete only the following fields:

- Applicant Information
- Type of Applicant (optional)
- Descriptive Title of Applicant's Project
- Proposed Project Start/Ending Dates

PHS 398 Cover Page Supplement (Administrative Core)

Enter Human Embryonic Stem Cells in each relevant component.

Research & Related Other Project Information (Administrative Core)

Human Subjects: Answer only the 'Are Human Subjects Involved?' and 'Is the Project Exempt from Federal regulations?' questions.

Vertebrate Animals: Answer only the 'Are Vertebrate Animals Used?' question.

Project Narrative: Do not complete. Note: ASSIST screens will show an asterisk for this attachment indicating it is required. However, eRA systems only enforce this requirement in the Overall component and applications will not receive an error if omitted in other components.

Project/Performance Site Location(s) (Administrative Core)

List all performance sites that apply to the specific component.

Note: The Project Performance Site form allows up to 300 sites, prior to using additional attachment for additional entries.

Research & Related Senior/Key Person Profile (Administrative Core)

- In the Project Director/Principal Investigator section of the form, use Project Role of 'Other' with Category of 'Core Lead' and provide a valid eRA Commons ID in the Credential field.
- In the additional Senior/Key Profiles section, list Senior/Key persons that are working in the component.
- Include a single Biographical Sketch for each Senior/Key person listed in the application regardless of the number of components in which they participate. When a Senior/Key person is listed in multiple components, the Biographical Sketch can be included in any one component.
- If more than 100 Senior/Key persons are included in a component, the Additional Senior Key Person attachments should be used.
- For institutions/organizations proposing a single PD/PI, the PD/PI will serve as the Administrative Core Lead. For institutions/organizations proposing multiple PD(s)/PI(s), the Contact PD/PI must serve as the Administrative Core Lead.

Budget (Administrative Core)

Budget forms appropriate for the specific component will be included in the application package.

- Include necessary expenses for the planning, implementation, and administration of the Data Management and Sharing Plan (DMSP).
-
- Include travel funds for the PD(s)/PI(s), Research Project Leaders and Core Leaders to attend the Kick-Off meeting, to be held within 6 months of award, in the Rockville, MD area (one and a half day meeting).
- Include travel funds for the PD(s)/PI(s), Research Project Leaders, Core Leaders, and presenters (at the discretion of the PD/PI) to attend Annual Programmatic meetings, to be held annually beginning in Year 2, in the Rockville, MD area or in the location of one of the TBRUs (one and a half day meeting). Funds may be included in support travel for early-stage investigators to attend the Annual Programmatic meetings.
- If appropriate, include travel funds for the External Scientific Advisory Group (ESAG) to attend the TBRU's annual internal programmatic meeting.

Note: The R&R Budget form included in many of the component types allows for up to 100 Senior/Key Persons in section A and 100 Equipment Items in section C prior to using attachments for additional entries. All other SF424 (R&R) instructions apply.

PHS 398 Research Plan (Administrative Core)

Specific Aims: List in priority order, the objectives and goals of the proposed Administrative Core. In addition, state the Core's relationship to the TBRU's goals and how it relates to individual Research Projects or Scientific Core(s) in the application.

Research Strategy: Describe plans and procedures for establishing and managing an Administrative Core that provides the organizational capacity to ensure the following:

- Coordinating, supervising, and managing all TBRU activities.
- Providing a supportive structure sufficient to ensure the accomplishment of all research goals, administrative support, fiscal and project management, implementation and oversight of subawards.
- Promoting collaboration and coordination among Research Project and Core Leaders.
- Promoting communication with other TBRUs regarding potential collaboration.
- Communicating and interacting with the NIAID Program Officer, or other staff.

Management Plan: Provide a Management Plan that describes the organization of the proposed TBRU and its management structure and how data will be shared internally between projects and cores. The Management Plan sections should be clearly indicated in the application. The Management Plan should include:

- A description of the organizational structure and roles of administrative staff, including the functions to be performed; how fiscal and other resources will be prioritized, allocated and managed; and how communications will be facilitated.
- An overview of how the Research Projects and Scientific Core(s) will be integrated and managed to form a cohesive, collaborative environment to answer the scientific questions and hypotheses proposed in the application.
- Plans for tracking of Research Project and Scientific Core progress, problem identification and resolution.
- Plans for sharing data internally between Research Projects and Cores.

External Scientific Advisory Group (ESAG): Each TBRU is encouraged to establish an ESAG, but this is not a requirement. If the TBRU proposes an ESAG, it should discuss the role of the ESAG, the procedures and approaches for obtaining ESAG input via teleconferences, ad hoc or annual meetings, review of written materials/data, etc. *Applicants MUST NOT name or contact potential external ESAG members in the application prior to award.*

Letters of Support: Include letters of support, if applicable.

Resource Sharing Plan: Individuals are required to comply with the instructions for the Resource Sharing Plans as provided in the How to Apply- Application Guide (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82400).

Appendix:

Only limited items are allowed in the Appendix. Follow all instructions for the How to Apply- Application Guide (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82400); any instructions provided here are in addition to those in the How to Apply- Application Guide (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82400) instructions.

PHS Human Subjects and Clinical Trials Information (Administrative Core)

When involving human subjects research, clinical research, and/or NIH-defined clinical trials follow all instructions for the PHS Human Subjects and Clinical Trials Information form in the How to Apply- Application Guide, (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82400) with the following additional instructions:

If you answered "Yes" to the question "Are Human Subjects Involved?" on the R&R Other Project Information form, you must include at least one human subjects study record using the **Study Record: PHS Human Subjects and Clinical Trials Information** form or a **Delayed Onset Study** record.

Study Record: PHS Human Subjects and Clinical Trials Information

All instructions in the How to Apply- Application Guide (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82400) must be followed.

Delayed Onset Study

Note: Delayed onset (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/glossary.htm#DelayedOnsetHumanSubjectStudy) does NOT apply to a study that can be described but will not start immediately (i.e., delayed start). All instructions in the How to Apply- Application Guide (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82400) must be followed.

Scientific Core(s)

When preparing your application, use Component Type 'Core.'

All instructions in the How to Apply- Application Guide (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82400)must be followed, with the following additional instructions, as noted.

SF424 (R&R) Cover (Scientific Core(s))

Complete only the following fields:

- Applicant Information
- Type of Applicant (optional)
- Descriptive Title of Applicant's Project
- Proposed Project Start/Ending Dates

PHS 398 Cover Page Supplement (Scientific Core(s))

Enter Human Embryonic Stem Cells in each relevant component.

Research & Related Other Project Information (Scientific Core(s))

Human Subjects: Answer only the 'Are Human Subjects Involved?' and 'Is the Project Exempt from Federal regulations?' questions.

Vertebrate Animals: Answer only the 'Are Vertebrate Animals Used?' question.

Project Narrative: Do not complete. Note: ASSIST screens will show an asterisk for this attachment indicating it is required. However, eRA systems only enforce this requirement in the Overall component and applications will not receive an error if omitted in other components.

Project/Performance Site Location(s) (Scientific Core(s))

List all performance sites that apply to the specific component.

Note: The Project Performance Site form allows up to 300 sites, prior to using additional attachment for additional entries.

Research & Related Senior/Key Person Profile (Scientific Core(s))

- In the Project Director/Principal Investigator section of the form, use Project Role of 'Other' with Category of 'Core Lead' and provide a valid eRA Commons ID in the Credential field.
- In the additional Senior/Key Profiles section, list Senior/Key persons that are working in the component.
- Include a single Biographical Sketch for each Senior/Key person listed in the application regardless of the number of components in which they participate. When a Senior/Key person is listed in multiple components, the Biographical Sketch can be included in any one component.
- If more than 100 Senior/Key persons are included in a component, the Additional Senior Key Person attachments should be used.

Budget (Scientific Core(s))

Budget forms appropriate for the specific component will be included in the application package.

Note: The R&R Budget form included in many of the component types allows for up to 100 Senior/Key Persons in section A and 100 Equipment Items in section C prior to using attachments for additional entries. All other SF424 (R&R) instructions apply.

PHS 398 Research Plan (Scientific Core(s))

Specific Aims: List in priority order, the broad, long-range objectives and goals of the proposed Scientific Core. In addition, state the Scientific Core's relationship to the TBRU's goals and how it relates to the individual Research Projects and other Scientific Core(s) (if any) in the application.

Research Strategy: Describe how the proposed Core activities will contribute to meeting the goals and objectives of the research proposed in the application and indicate the specific two or more Research Projects that it will support. Explain the rationale for the general methods and approaches proposed to accomplish the Specific Aims. Include details of the facilities, resources, and professional skills provided and explain how requests for services will be prioritized and coordinated.

If a clinical site is part of a Scientific Core (e.g. as a source of clinical samples) describe how the proposed clinical site(s) match the requirements for this NOFO: i.e., the clinical site(s) must be in and/or treat a community where TB is prevalent and has an established infrastructure, including experienced local investigators capable of conducting human TB studies that meet US regulatory requirements for the protection of human subjects, adequate laboratory facilities and personnel to perform protocol-specific tests, access to patient populations that are suitable to study bacterial and host factors, as well as their relation to TB disease presentation and HIV status.

Letters of Support: Provide letters of support that are applicable to the Scientific Core.

Resource Sharing Plan: Individuals are required to comply with the instructions for the Resource Sharing Plans as provided in the How to Apply- Application Guide (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82400).

Appendix:

Only limited items are allowed in the Appendix. Follow all instructions for the How to Apply- Application Guide (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82400); any instructions provided here are in addition to those in the How to Apply- Application Guide (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82400) instructions.

PHS Human Subjects and Clinical Trials Information (Scientific Core(s))

When involving human subjects research, clinical research, and/or NIH-defined clinical trials follow all instructions for the PHS Human Subjects and Clinical Trials Information form in the How to Apply- Application Guide, (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82400) with the following additional instructions:

If you answered "Yes" to the question "Are Human Subjects Involved?" on the R&R Other Project Information form, you must include at least one human subjects study record using the **Study Record: PHS Human Subjects and Clinical Trials Information** form or a **Delayed Onset Study** record.

Study Record: PHS Human Subjects and Clinical Trials Information

All instructions in the How to Apply- Application Guide (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82400) must be followed.

Delayed Onset Study

Note: Delayed onset (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/glossary.htm#DelayedOnsetHumanSubjectStudy) does NOT apply to a study that can be described but will not start immediately (i.e., delayed start). All instructions in the How to Apply- Application Guide (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82400) must be followed.

Research Projects

When preparing your application, use Component Type 'Project.'

All instructions in the How to Apply- Application Guide (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82400)must be followed, with the following additional instructions, as noted.

SF424 (R&R) Cover (Research Projects)

Complete only the following fields:

- Applicant Information
- Type of Applicant (optional)
- Descriptive Title of Applicant's Project
- Proposed Project Start/Ending Dates

PHS 398 Cover Page Supplement (Research Projects)

Enter Human Embryonic Stem Cells in each relevant component.

Research & Related Other Project Information (Research Projects)

Human Subjects: Answer only the 'Are Human Subjects Involved?' and 'Is the Project Exempt from Federal regulations?' questions.

Vertebrate Animals: Answer only the 'Are Vertebrate Animals Used?' question.

Project Narrative: Do not complete. Note: ASSIST screens will show an asterisk for this attachment indicating it is required. However, eRA systems only enforce this requirement in the Overall component and applications will not receive an error if omitted in other components.

Project/Performance Site Location(s) (Research Projects)

List all performance sites that apply to the specific component.

Note: The Project Performance Site form allows up to 300 sites, prior to using additional attachment for additional entries.

Research & Related Senior/Key Person Profile (Research Projects)

- In the Project Director/Principal Investigator section of the form, use Project Role of 'Other' with Category of 'Project Lead' and provide a valid eRA Commons ID in the Credential field.
- In the additional Senior/Key Profiles section, list Senior/Key persons that are working in the component.
- Include a single Biographical Sketch for each Senior/Key person listed in the application regardless of the number of components in which they participate. When a Senior/Key person is listed in multiple components, the Biographical Sketch can be included in any one component.
- If more than 100 Senior/Key persons are included in a component, the Additional Senior Key Person attachments should be used.

Budget (Research Projects)

Budget forms appropriate for the specific component will be included in the application package.

Note: The R&R Budget form included in many of the component types allows for up to 100 Senior/Key Persons in section A and 100 Equipment Items in section C prior to using attachments for additional entries. All other SF424 (R&R) instructions apply.

PHS 398 Research Plan (Research Projects)

Specific Aims: List, in priority order, the broad long-range objectives and goals of the proposed Research Project. Concisely describe the hypothesis or hypotheses to be tested. In addition, state the individual Research Project's relationship to the TBRU's goals and how it relates to other Research Projects or Scientific Core(s) in the application.

Research Strategy: Describe how the proposed Research Project will contribute to meeting the TBRU's overall goals and explain the rationale for the methods and approaches proposed to accomplish the Specific Aims. State the biological significance of the research and indicate the project's relevance to the primary theme of the application. Describe the research design, methodologies, and analyses to be used to carry out the Specific Aims of the project. Describe any novel concepts, approaches, or tools to be utilized. Discuss the potential difficulties and limitations of the proposed procedures and alternative approaches to achieve the aims. As part of this section, provide a tentative sequence or timetable for the project.

If a clinical site is part of a Research Project (e.g. as a source of clinical samples) describe how the proposed clinical site(s) match the requirements for this NOFO: i.e., the clinical site(s) must be in and/or treat a community where TB is prevalent and has an established infrastructure, including experienced local investigators capable of conducting human TB studies that meet US regulatory requirements for the protection of human subjects, adequate laboratory facilities and personnel to perform protocol-specific tests, access to patient populations that are suitable to study bacterial and host factors, as well as their relation to TB disease presentation and HIV status.

Letters of Support: Provide letters of support that are applicable to the individual Research Projects.

Resource Sharing Plan: Individuals are required to comply with the instructions for the Resource Sharing Plans as provided in the How to Apply- Application Guide (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82400).

Appendix:

Only limited items are allowed in the Appendix. Follow all instructions for the How to Apply- Application Guide (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82400); any instructions provided here are in addition to those in the How to Apply- Application Guide (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82400) instructions.

PHS Human Subjects and Clinical Trials Information (Research Projects)

When involving human subjects research, clinical research, and/or NIH-defined clinical trials follow all instructions for the PHS Human Subjects and Clinical Trials Information form in the How to Apply- Application Guide, (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82400) with the following additional instructions:

If you answered "Yes" to the question "Are Human Subjects Involved?" on the R&R Other Project Information form, you must include at least one human subjects study record using the **Study Record: PHS Human Subjects and Clinical Trials Information** form or a **Delayed Onset Study** record.

Study Record: PHS Human Subjects and Clinical Trials Information

All instructions in the How to Apply- Application Guide (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82400) must be followed.

Delayed Onset Study

Note: Delayed onset (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/glossary.htm#DelayedOnsetHumanSubjectStudy) does NOT apply to a study that can be described but will not start immediately (i.e., delayed start). All instructions in the How to Apply- Application Guide (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82400) must be followed.

Foreign Organizations

Foreign (non-U.S.) organizations must follow policies described in the NIH Grants Policy Statement (//grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=11137), and procedures for foreign institutions described throughout the How to Apply - Application Guide (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82400).

3. Unique Entity Identifier and System for Award Management (SAM)

See Part 2. Section III.1 for information regarding the requirement for obtaining a unique entity identifier and for completing and maintaining active registrations in System for Award Management (SAM), NATO Commercial and Government Entity (NCAGE) Code (if applicable), eRA Commons, and Grants.gov

4. Submission Dates and Times

Part I. contains information about Key Dates and times. Applicants are encouraged to submit applications before the due date to ensure they have time to make any application corrections that might be necessary for successful submission. When a submission date falls on a weekend or Federal holiday (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82380), the application deadline is automatically extended to the next business day.

Organizations must submit applications to Grants.gov (//grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=11128) (the online portal to find and apply for grants across all Federal agencies) using ASSIST or other electronic submission systems. Applicants must then complete the submission process by tracking the status of the application in the eRA Commons (//grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=11123), NIH's electronic system for grants administration. NIH and Grants.gov systems check the application against many of the application instructions upon submission. Errors must be corrected and a changed/corrected application must be submitted to Grants.gov on or before the application due date and time. If a Changed/Corrected application is submitted after the deadline, the application will be considered late. Applications that miss the due date and time are subjected to the NIH Grants Policy Statement Section 2.3.9.2 Electronically Submitted Applications (//grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82423).

Applicants are responsible for viewing their application before the due date in the eRA Commons to ensure accurate and successful submission.

Information on the submission process and a definition of on-time submission are provided in How to Apply- Application Guide. (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82400)

5. Intergovernmental Review (E.O. 12372)

This initiative is not subject to intergovernmental review (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/policy/nihgps/html5/section_10/10.10.1_executive_orders.htm).

6. Funding Restrictions

All NIH awards are subject to the terms and conditions, cost principles, and other considerations described in the NIH Grants Policy Statement (//grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=11120).

Pre-award costs are allowable only as described in the NIH Grants Policy Statement (//grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=11143) Section 7.9.1 Selected Items of Cost. (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/policy/nihgps/HTML5/section_7/7.9_allowability_of_costs_activities.htm#Selected)

7. Other Submission Requirements and Information

Applications must be submitted electronically following the instructions described in the How to Apply - Application Guide (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82400). Paper applications will not be accepted.

For information on how applications will be automatically assembled for review and funding consideration after submission, refer to: http://grants.nih.gov/grants/ElectronicReceipt/files/Electronic_Multi-project_Application_Image_Assembly.pdf (//grants.nih.gov/grants/ElectronicReceipt/files/Electronic_Multi-project_Application_Image_Assembly.pdf).

Applicants must complete all required registrations before the application due date. Section III. Eligibility Information contains information about registration.

For assistance with your electronic application or for more information on the electronic submission process, visit How to Apply - Application Guide (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82400). If you encounter a system issue beyond your control that threatens your ability to complete the submission process on-time, you must follow the Dealing with System Issues (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/how-to-apply-application-guide/due-dates-and-submission-policies/dealing-with-system-issues.htm) guidance. For assistance with application submission, contact the Application Submission Contacts in Section VII.

Important reminders:

All PD(s)/PI(s) and component Project Leads must include their eRA Commons ID in the Credential field of the Senior/Key Person Profile form**.** Failure to register in the Commons and to include a valid PD/PI Commons ID in the credential field will prevent the successful submission of an electronic application to NIH.

The applicant organization must ensure that the unique entity identifier provided on the application is the same identifier used in the organization's profile in the eRA Commons and for the System for Award Management. Additional information may be found in How to Apply - Application Guide (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82400).

See more tips (//grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=11146) for avoiding common errors.

Upon receipt, applications will be evaluated for completeness and compliance with application instructions by the Center for Scientific Review and responsiveness by the National Institute of Allergy and Infectious Diseases, NIH. Applications that are incomplete, non-compliant and/or nonresponsive will not be reviewed.

Mandatory Disclosure

Recipients or subrecipients must submit any information related to violations of federal criminal law involving fraud, bribery, or gratuity violations potentially affecting the federal award. See Mandatory Disclosures, 2 CFR 200.113 (https://www.ecfr.gov/current/title-2/subtitle-A/chapter-II/part-200/subpart-B/section-200.113) and NIH Grants Policy Statement Section 4.1.35 (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/policy/nihgps/html5/section_4/4.1.35_mandatory_disclosures.htm).

Send written disclosures to the NIH Chief Grants Management Officer listed on the Notice of Award for the IC that funded the award and to the HHS Office of Inspector Grant Self Disclosure Program (https://oig.hhs.gov/compliance/self-disclosure-info/hhs-oig-grant-self-disclosure-program/) at grantdisclosures@oig.hhs.gov (mailto:grantdisclosures@oig.hhs.gov).

Post Submission Materials

Applicants are required to follow the instructions for post-submission materials, as described in the policy (//grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82299).

Section V. Application Review Information

1. Criteria

Only the review criteria described below will be considered in the review process. Applications submitted to NIH in support of the NIH mission (//grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=11149) are evaluated for scientific and technical merit through the NIH peer review system.

A proposed Clinical Trial application may include study design, methods, and intervention that are not by themselves innovative but address important questions or unmet needs. Additionally, the results of the clinical trial may indicate that further clinical development of the intervention is unwarranted or lead to new avenues of scientific investigation.

Overall Impact - Overall

Reviewers will provide an overall impact score to reflect their assessment of the likelihood for the project to exert a sustained, powerful influence on the research field(s) involved, in consideration of the following review criteria and additional review criteria (as applicable for the project proposed).

Scored Review Criteria - Overall

Reviewers will consider each of the review criteria below in the determination of scientific merit and give a separate score for each. An application does not need to be strong in all categories to be judged likely to have major scientific impact. For example, a project that by its nature is not innovative may be essential to advance a field.

Significance

Does the project address an important problem or a critical barrier to progress in the field? Is the prior research that serves as the key support for the proposed project rigorous? If the aims of the project are achieved, how will scientific knowledge, technical capability, and/or clinical practice be improved? How will successful completion of the aims change the concepts, methods, technologies, treatments, services, or preventative interventions that drive this field?

***Specific to this NOFO*:**

How well are the overall TBRU goals focused on an important area relevant to combating TB? To what degree is the TBRU as a whole scientifically compelling?

In addition, for applications involving clinical trials

Are the scientific rationale and need for a clinical trial to test the proposed hypothesis or intervention well supported by preliminary data, clinical and/or preclinical studies, or information in the literature or knowledge of biological mechanisms? For trials focusing on clinical or public health endpoints, is this clinical trial necessary for testing the safety, efficacy or effectiveness of an intervention that could lead to a change in clinical practice, community behaviors or health care policy? For trials focusing on mechanistic, behavioral, physiological, biochemical, or other biomedical endpoints, is this trial needed to advance scientific understanding?

Investigator(s)

Are the PD(s)/PI(s), collaborators, and other researchers well suited to the project? If Early Stage Investigators or those in the early stages of independent careers, do they have appropriate experience and training? If established, have they demonstrated an ongoing record of accomplishments that have advanced their field(s)? If the project is collaborative or multi-PD/PI, do the investigators have complementary and integrated expertise; are their leadership approach, governance and organizational structure appropriate for the project?

In addition, for applications involving clinical trials

With regard to the proposed leadership for the project, do the PD/PI(s) and key personnel have the expertise, experience, and ability to organize, manage and implement the proposed clinical trial and meet milestones and timelines? Do they have appropriate expertise in study coordination, data management and statistics? For a multicenter trial, is the organizational structure appropriate and does the application identify a core of potential center investigators and staffing for a coordinating center?

Innovation

Does the application challenge and seek to shift current research or clinical practice paradigms by utilizing novel theoretical concepts, approaches or methodologies, instrumentation, or interventions? Are the concepts, approaches or methodologies, instrumentation, or interventions novel to one field of research or novel in a broad sense? Is a refinement, improvement, or new application of theoretical concepts, approaches or methodologies, instrumentation, or interventions proposed?

In addition, for applications involving clinical trials

Does the design/research plan include innovative elements, as appropriate, that enhance its sensitivity, potential for information or potential to advance scientific knowledge or clinical practice?

Approach

Are the overall strategy, methodology, and analyses well-reasoned and appropriate to accomplish the specific aims of the project? Have the investigators included plans to address weaknesses in the rigor of prior research that serves as the key support for the proposed project? Have the investigators presented strategies to ensure a robust and unbiased approach, as appropriate for the work proposed? Are potential problems, alternative strategies, and benchmarks for success presented? If the project is in the early stages of development, will the strategy establish feasibility and will particularly risky aspects be managed? Have the investigators presented adequate plans to address relevant biological variables, such as sex, for studies in vertebrate animals or human subjects?

If the project involves human subjects and/or NIH-defined clinical research, are the plans to address:

1) the protection of human subjects from research risks, and
2) inclusion (or exclusion) of individuals on the basis of sex, race, and ethnicity, as well as the inclusion or exclusion of individuals of all ages (including children and older adults), justified in terms of the scientific goals and research strategy proposed?

Specific to this NOFO:

To what degree are the Individual Research Projects and Scientific Core(s) integrated and synergistic to accomplish the central objectives of the TBRU? To what extent will the integration of the individual projects into a single TBRU be more beneficial than pursuing each project independently?

In addition, for applications involving clinical trials

Does the application adequately address the following, if applicable

Study Design

Is the study design justified and appropriate to address primary and secondary outcome variable(s)/endpoints that will be clear, informative and relevant to the hypothesis being tested? Is the scientific rationale/premise of the study based on previously well-designed preclinical and/or clinical research? Given the methods used to assign participants and deliver interventions, is the study design adequately powered to answer the research question(s), test the proposed hypothesis/hypotheses, and provide interpretable results? Is the trial appropriately designed to conduct the research efficiently? Are the study populations (size, sex, age, demographic group), proposed intervention arms/dose, and duration of the trial, appropriate and well justified?

Are potential ethical issues adequately addressed? Is the process for obtaining informed consent or assent appropriate? Is the eligible population available? Are the plans for recruitment outreach, enrollment, retention, handling dropouts, missed visits, and losses to follow-up appropriate to ensure robust data collection? Are the planned recruitment timelines feasible and is the plan to monitor accrual adequate? Has the need for randomization (or not), masking (if appropriate), controls, and inclusion/exclusion criteria been addressed? Are differences addressed, if applicable, in the intervention effect due to sex and race/ethnicity?

Are the plans to standardize, assure quality of, and monitor adherence to, the trial protocol and data collection or distribution guidelines appropriate? Is there a plan to obtain required study agent(s)? Does the application propose to use existing available resources, as applicable?

Data Management and Statistical Analysis

Are planned analyses and statistical approach appropriate for the proposed study design and methods used to assign participants and deliver interventions? Are the procedures for data management and quality control of data adequate at clinical site(s) or at center laboratories, as applicable? Have the methods for standardization of procedures for data management to assess the effect of the intervention and quality control been addressed? Is there a plan to complete data analysis within the proposed period of the award?

Environment

Will the scientific environment in which the work will be done contribute to the probability of success? Are the institutional support, equipment and other physical resources available to the investigators adequate for the project proposed? Will the project benefit from unique features of the scientific environment, subject populations, or collaborative arrangements?

In addition, for applications involving clinical trials

If proposed, are the administrative, data coordinating, enrollment and laboratory/testing centers, appropriate for the trial proposed?

Does the application adequately address the capability and ability to conduct the trial at the proposed site(s) or centers? Are the plans to add or drop enrollment centers, as needed, appropriate?

If international site(s) is/are proposed, does the application adequately address the complexity of executing the clinical trial?

If multi-sites/centers, is there evidence of the ability of the individual site or center to: (1) enroll the proposed numbers; (2) adhere to the protocol; (3) collect and transmit data in an accurate and timely fashion; and, (4) operate within the proposed organizational structure?

Overall Impact – Individual Research Projects

Reviewers will provide an overall impact score to reflect their assessment of the likelihood for the project to exert a sustained, powerful influence on the research field(s) involved, in consideration of the following review criteria and additional review criteria (as applicable for the project proposed).

Review Criteria – Individual Research Projects

Reviewers will consider each of the review criteria below in the determination of scientific merit. An application does not need to be strong in all categories to be judged likely to have major scientific impact. For example, a project that by its nature is not innovative may be essential to advance a field.

Significance

Does the project address an important problem or a critical barrier to progress in the field? Is the prior research that serves as the key support for the proposed project rigorous? If the aims of the project are achieved, how will scientific knowledge, technical capability, and/or clinical practice be improved? How will successful completion of the aims change the concepts, methods, technologies, treatments, services, or preventative interventions that drive this field?

In addition, for applications involving clinical trials

Are the scientific rationale and need for a clinical trial to test the proposed hypothesis or intervention well supported by preliminary data, clinical and/or preclinical studies, or information in the literature or knowledge of biological mechanisms? For trials focusing on clinical or public health endpoints, is this clinical trial necessary for testing the safety, efficacy or effectiveness of an intervention that could lead to a change in clinical practice, community behaviors or health care policy? For trials focusing on mechanistic, behavioral, physiological, biochemical, or other biomedical endpoints, is this trial needed to advance scientific understanding?

Investigator(s)

Are the PD(s)/PI(s), collaborators, and other researchers well suited to the project? If Early Stage Investigators or those in the early stages of independent careers, do they have appropriate experience and training? If established, have they demonstrated an ongoing record of accomplishments that have advanced their field(s)? If the project is collaborative or multi-PD/PI, do the investigators have complementary and integrated expertise; are their leadership approach, governance and organizational structure appropriate for the project?

In addition, for applications involving clinical trials

With regard to the proposed leadership for the project, do the PD/PI(s) and key personnel have the expertise, experience, and ability to organize, manage and implement the proposed clinical trial and meet milestones and timelines? Do they have appropriate expertise in study coordination, data management and statistics? For a multicenter trial, is the organizational structure appropriate and does the application identify a core of potential center investigators and staffing for a coordinating center?

Innovation

Does the application challenge and seek to shift current research or clinical practice paradigms by utilizing novel theoretical concepts, approaches or methodologies, instrumentation, or interventions? Are the concepts, approaches or methodologies, instrumentation, or interventions novel to one field of research or novel in a broad sense? Is a refinement, improvement, or new application of theoretical concepts, approaches or methodologies, instrumentation, or interventions proposed?

In addition, for applications involving clinical trials

Does the design/research plan include innovative elements, as appropriate, that enhance its sensitivity, potential for information or potential to advance scientific knowledge or clinical practice?

Approach

Are the overall strategy, methodology, and analyses well-reasoned and appropriate to accomplish the specific aims of the project? Have investigators included plans to address weaknesses in the rigor of prior research that serves as the key support for the proposed project? Have the investigators presented strategies to ensure a robust and unbiased approach, as appropriate for the work proposed? Are potential problems, alternative strategies, and benchmarks for success presented? If the project is in the early stages of development, will the strategy establish feasibility and will particularly risky aspects be managed? Have the investigators presented adequate plans to address relevant biological variables, such as sex, for studies in vertebrate animals or human subjects?

If the project involves human subjects and/or NIH-defined clinical research, are the plans to address:

1) the protection of human subjects from research risks, and

2) inclusion (or exclusion) of individuals on the basis of sex, race, and ethnicity, as well as the inclusion or exclusion of individuals of all ages (including children and older adults), justified in terms of the scientific goals and research strategy proposed?

In addition, for applications involving clinical trials

Does the application adequately address the following, if applicable

Study Design
Is the study design justified and appropriate to address primary and secondary outcome variable(s)/endpoints that will be clear, informative and relevant to the hypothesis being tested? Is the scientific rationale/premise of the study based on previously well-designed preclinical and/or clinical research? Given the methods used to assign participants and deliver interventions, is the study design adequately powered to answer the research question(s), test the proposed hypothesis/hypotheses, and provide interpretable results? Is the trial appropriately designed to conduct the research efficiently? Are the study populations (size, sex, age, demographic group), proposed intervention arms/dose, and duration of the trial, appropriate and well justified?

Are potential ethical issues adequately addressed? Is the process for obtaining informed consent or assent appropriate? Is the eligible population available? Are the plans for recruitment outreach, enrollment, retention, handling dropouts, missed visits, and losses to follow-up appropriate to ensure robust data collection? Are the planned recruitment timelines feasible and is the plan to monitor accrual adequate? Has the need for randomization (or not), masking (if appropriate), controls, and inclusion/exclusion criteria been addressed? Are differences addressed, if applicable, in the intervention effect due to sex and race/ethnicity?

Are the plans to standardize, assure quality of, and monitor adherence to, the trial protocol and data collection or distribution guidelines appropriate? Is there a plan to obtain required study agent(s)? Does the application propose to use existing available resources, as applicable?

Data Management and Statistical Analysis
Are planned analyses and statistical approach appropriate for the proposed study design and methods used to assign participants and deliver interventions? Are the procedures for data management and quality control of data adequate at clinical site(s) or at center laboratories, as applicable? Have the methods for standardization of procedures for data management to assess the effect of the intervention and quality control been addressed? Is there a plan to complete data analysis within the proposed period of the award?

Environment

Will the scientific environment in which the work will be done contribute to the probability of success? Are the institutional support, equipment and other physical resources available to the investigators adequate for the project proposed? Will the project benefit from unique features of the scientific environment, subject populations, or collaborative arrangements?

In addition, for applications involving clinical trials

If proposed, are the administrative, data coordinating, enrollment and laboratory/testing centers, appropriate for the trial proposed?

Does the application adequately address the capability and ability to conduct the trial at the proposed site(s) or centers? Are the plans to add or drop enrollment centers, as needed, appropriate?

If international site(s) is/are proposed, does the application adequately address the complexity of executing the clinical trial?

If multi-sites/centers, is there evidence of the ability of the individual site or center to: (1) enroll the proposed numbers; (2) adhere to the protocol; (3) collect and transmit data in an accurate and timely fashion; and, (4) operate within the proposed organizational structure?

Overall Impact - Administrative and Scientific Core(s)

Reviewers will provide an overall impact score for each Core to reflect their assessment of the likelihood for the Core to exert a sustained, powerful influence on the research field(s) involved, in consideration of the following review criteria and additional review criteria (as applicable for the core proposed).

Administrative Core

- How adequate and appropriate are the plans and procedures outlined for the Administrative Core for accomplishment of the TBRU's goals?
- How well developed is the Management Plan to facilitate achievement of the objectives of the proposed TBRU?
- How appropriate is the Management Plan for fiscal accountability and communication within the TBRU and with NIAID staff?
- How well justified are the plans for coordination, problem identification and resolution, and establishment of a strong collaborative environment for the TBRU?
- How adequate and appropriate are the experience and level of commitment of the Administrative Core Leader and staff to manage the TBRU?

Scientific Core(s)

- How well is/are the proposed Scientific Core(s) justified and relevant to the theme of the overall TBRU?
- How well justified is it that each Scientific Core will support at least two Research Projects and that services will be used effectively?
- How adequate is/are the quality of facilities or services provided by the Core(s)?
- How appropriate are the qualifications and commitment of the Core Leader and key personnel?

Additional Review Criteria – Overall, Administrative Core, Scientific Core(s) and Research Projects

As applicable for the project proposed, reviewers will evaluate the following additional items while determining scientific and technical merit, and in providing an overall impact score, but will not give separate scores for these items.

Study Timeline

Specific to applications involving clinical trials

Is the study timeline described in detail, taking into account start-up activities, the anticipated rate of enrollment, and planned follow-up assessment? Is the projected timeline feasible and well justified? Does the project incorporate efficiencies and utilize existing resources (e.g., CTSAs, practice-based research networks, electronic medical records, administrative database, or patient registries) to increase the efficiency of participant enrollment and data collection, as appropriate?

Are potential challenges and corresponding solutions discussed (e.g., strategies that can be implemented in the event of enrollment shortfalls)?

Protections for Human Subjects

For research that involves human subjects but does not involve one of the categories of research that are exempt under 45 CFR Part 46, the committee will evaluate the justification for involvement of human subjects and the proposed protections from research risk relating to their participation according to the following five review criteria: 1) risk to subjects, 2) adequacy of protection against risks, 3) potential benefits to the subjects and others, 4) importance of the knowledge to be gained, and 5) data and safety monitoring for clinical trials.

For research that involves human subjects and meets the criteria for one or more of the categories of research that are exempt under 45 CFR Part 46, the committee will evaluate: 1) the justification for the exemption, 2) human subjects involvement and characteristics, and 3) sources of materials. For additional information on review of the Human Subjects section, please refer to the Guidelines for the Review of Human Subjects (//grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=11175).

Inclusion of Human Subjects Policies

When the proposed project involves human subjects and/or NIH-defined clinical research, the committee will evaluate the proposed plans for inclusion. For additional information on review of the Inclusion section, please refer to the Guidelines for the Review of Inclusion in Clinical Research (//grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=11174).

Vertebrate Animals

The committee will evaluate the involvement of live vertebrate animals as part of the scientific assessment according to the following three points: (1) a complete description of all proposed procedures including the species, strains, ages, sex, and total numbers of animals to be used; (2) justifications that the species is appropriate for the proposed research and why the research goals cannot be accomplished using an alternative non-animal model; and (3) interventions including analgesia, anesthesia, sedation, palliative care, and humane endpoints that will be used to limit any unavoidable discomfort, distress, pain and injury in the conduct of scientifically valuable research. Methods of euthanasia and justification for selected methods, if NOT consistent with the American Veterinary Medicine Association (AVMA) Guidelines for the Euthanasia of Animals, is also required but is found in a separate section of the application. For additional information on review of the Vertebrate Animals Section, please refer to the Worksheet for Review of the Vertebrate Animals Section. (//grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=11150)

Biohazards

Reviewers will assess whether materials or procedures proposed are potentially hazardous to research personnel and/or the environment, and if needed, determine whether adequate protection is proposed.

Resubmissions

Not Applicable

Renewals

For Renewals, the committee will consider the progress made in the last funding period.

Revisions

Not Applicable

Additional Review Considerations – Overall, Administrative Core, Scientific Core(s) and Research Projects

As applicable for the project proposed, reviewers will consider each of the following items, but will not give scores for these items, and should not consider them in providing an overall impact score.

Applications from Foreign Organizations

Reviewers will assess whether the project presents special opportunities for furthering research programs through the use of unusual talent, resources, populations, or environmental conditions that exist in other countries and either are not readily available in the United States or augment existing U.S. resources.

Select Agent Research

Reviewers will assess the information provided in this section of the application, including 1) the Select Agent(s) to be used in the proposed research, 2) the registration status of all entities where Select Agent(s) will be used, 3) the procedures that will be used to monitor possession use and transfer of Select Agent(s), and 4) plans for appropriate biosafety, biocontainment, and security of the Select Agent(s).

Resource Sharing Plans

Reviewers will comment on whether the Resource Sharing Plan(s) (e.g., Sharing Model Organisms (https://sharing.nih.gov/other-sharing-policies/model-organism-sharing-policy#policy-overview)) or the rationale for not sharing the resources, is reasonable.

Authentication of Key Biological and/or Chemical Resources:

For projects involving key biological and/or chemical resources, reviewers will comment on the brief plans proposed for identifying and ensuring the validity of those resources.

Budget and Period of Support

Reviewers will consider whether the budget and the requested period of support are fully justified and reasonable in relation to the proposed research.

2. Review and Selection Process

Applications will be evaluated for scientific and technical merit by (an) appropriate Scientific Review Group(s) convened by the Center for Scientific Review (CSR), in accordance with NIH peer review policies and practices (//grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=11154), using the stated review criteria. Assignment to a Scientific Review Group will be shown in the eRA Commons.

As part of the scientific peer review, all applications will receive a written critique.

Applications may undergo a selection process in which only those applications deemed to have the highest scientific and technical merit (generally the top half of applications under review) will be discussed and assigned an overall impact score.

Appeals (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/policy/nihgps/html5/section_2/2.4.2_appeals_of_initial_scientific_review.htm) of initial peer review will not be accepted for applications submitted in response to this NOFO.

Applications will be assigned to the appropriate NIH Institute or Center. Applications will compete for available funds with all other recommended applications submitted in response to this NOFO. Following initial peer review, recommended applications will receive a second level of review by tthe National Advisory Allergy and Infectious Diseases Council. The following will be considered in making funding decisions:

- Scientific and technical merit of the proposed project as determined by scientific peer review.
- Availability of funds.
- Relevance of the proposed project to program priorities.

If the application is under consideration for funding, NIH will request "just-in-time" information from the applicant as described in the NIH Grants Policy Statement Section 2.5.1. Just-in-Time Procedures (//grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82418). This request is not a Notice of Award nor should it be construed to be an indicator of possible funding.

Prior to making an award, NIH reviews an applicant's federal award history in SAM.gov to ensure sound business practices. An applicant can review and comment on any information in the Responsibility/Qualification records available in SAM.gov. NIH will consider any comments by the applicant in the Responsibility/Qualification records in SAM.gov to ascertain the applicant's integrity, business ethics, and performance record of managing Federal awards per 2 CFR Part 200.206 "Federal awarding agency review of risk posed by applicants." This provision will apply to all NIH grants and cooperative agreements except fellowships.

3. Anticipated Announcement and Award Dates

After the peer review of the application is completed, the PD/PI will be able to access their Summary Statement (written critique) via the eRA Commons (//grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=11123). Refer to Part 1 for dates for peer review, advisory council review, and earliest start date.

Information regarding the disposition of applications is available in the NIH Grants Policy Statement Section 2.4.4 Disposition of Applications (//grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82416).

Section VI. Award Administration Information

1. Award Notices

A Notice of Award (NoA) is the official authorizing document notifying the applicant that an award has been made and that funds may be requested from the designated HHS payment system or office. The NoA is signed by the Grants Management Officer and emailed to the recipient's business official.

In accepting the award, the recipient agrees that any activities under the award are subject to all provisions currently in effect or implemented during the period of the award, other Department regulations and policies in effect at the time of the award, and applicable statutory provisions.

Recipients must comply with any funding restrictions described in Section IV.6. Funding Restrictions. Any pre-award costs incurred before receipt of the NoA are at the applicant's own risk. For more information on the Notice of Award, please refer to the NIH Grants Policy Statement Section 5. The Notice of Award (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/policy/nihgps/HTML5/section_5/5_the_notice_of_award.htm) and NIH Grants & Funding website, see Award Process. (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/pre-award-process.htm#award)

Individual awards are based on the application submitted to, and as approved by, the NIH and are subject to the IC-specific terms and conditions identified in the NoA.

ClinicalTrials.gov: If an award provides for one or more clinical trials. By law (Title VIII, Section 801 of Public Law 110-85), the "responsible party" must register and submit results information for certain "applicable clinical trials" on the ClinicalTrials.gov Protocol Registration and Results System Information Website (https://register.clinicaltrials.gov (https://register.clinicaltrials.gov/)). NIH expects registration and results reporting of all trials whether required under the law or not. For more information, see https://grants.nih.gov/policy/clinical-trials/reporting/index.htm (https://grants.nih.gov/policy/clinical-trials/reporting/index.htm)

Institutional Review Board or Independent Ethics Committee Approval: Grantee institutions must ensure that all protocols are reviewed by their IRB or IEC. To help ensure the safety of participants enrolled in NIH-funded studies, the recipient must provide NIH copies of documents related to all major changes in the status of ongoing protocols.

Data and Safety Monitoring Requirements: The NIH policy for data and safety monitoring requires oversight and monitoring of all NIH-conducted or -supported human biomedical and behavioral intervention studies (clinical trials) to ensure the safety of participants and the validity and integrity of the data. Further information concerning these requirements is found at http://grants.nih.gov/grants/policy/hs/data_safety.htm and in the application instructions (SF424 (R&R) and PHS 398).

Investigational New Drug or Investigational Device Exemption Requirements: Consistent with federal regulations, clinical research projects involving the use of investigational therapeutics, vaccines, or other medical interventions (including licensed products and devices for a purpose other than that for which they were licensed) in humans under a research protocol must be performed under a Food and Drug Administration (FDA) investigational new drug (IND) or investigational device exemption (IDE).

2. Administrative and National Policy Requirements

The following Federal wide and HHS-specific policy requirements apply to awards funded through NIH:

- The rules listed at 2 CFR Part 200 (https://www.ecfr.gov/current/title-2/subtitle-A/chapter-II/part-200), Uniform Administrative Requirements, Cost Principles, and Audit Requirements for Federal Awards.
- All NIH grant and cooperative agreement awards include the NIH Grants Policy Statement (//grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=11120) as part of the terms and conditions in the Notice of Award (NoA). The NoA includes the requirements of this NOFO. For these terms of award, see the NIH Grants Policy Statement Part II: Terms and Conditions of NIH Grant Awards, Subpart A: General (//grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=11120) and Part II: Terms and Conditions of NIH Grant Awards, Subpart B: Terms and Conditions for Specific Types of Grants, Recipients, and Activities (//grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=11159).

All federal statutes and regulations relevant to federal financial assistance, including those highlighted in NIH Grants Policy Statement Section 4 Public Policy Requirements, Objectives and Other Appropriation Mandates. (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/policy/nihgps/HTML5/section_4/4_public_policy_requirements__objectives_and_other_appropriation_mandates.htm)

Recipients are responsible for ensuring that their activities comply with all applicable federal regulations. NIH may terminate awards under certain circumstances. See 2 CFR Part 200.340 Termination (https://www.ecfr.gov/current/title-2/subtitle-A/chapter-II/part-200/subpart-D/subject-group-ECFR86b76dde0e1e9dc/section-200.340) and NIH Grants Policy Statement Section 8.5.2 Remedies for Noncompliance or Enforcement Actions: Suspension, Termination, and Withholding of Support (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/policy/nihgps/html5/section_8/8.5.2_remedies_for_noncompliance_or_enforcement_actions-_suspension__termination__and_withholding_of_support.htm).

Pursuant to the Cybersecurity Act of 2015, Div. N, § 405, Pub. Law 114-113, 6 USC § 1533(d), the HHS Secretary has established a common set of voluntary, consensus-based, and industry-led guidelines, best practices, methodologies, procedures, and processes.

Successful recipients under this NOFO agree that:

When recipients, subrecipients, or third-party entities have:

1. ongoing and consistent access to HHS owned or operated information or operational technology systems; and
2. receive, maintain, transmit, store, access, exchange, process, or utilize personal identifiable information (PII) or personal health information (PHI) obtained from the awarding HHS agency for the purposes of executing the award.

Recipients shall develop plans and procedures, modeled after the NIST Cybersecurity framework (https://www.nist.gov/cyberframework), to protect HHS systems and data. Please refer to NIH Post-Award Monitoring and Reporting (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/post-award-monitoring-and-reporting.htm) for additional information.

Cooperative Agreement Terms and Conditions of Award

Not Applicable

3. Data Management and Sharing

Consistent with the 2023 NIH Policy for Data Management and Sharing, when data management and sharing is applicable to the award, recipients will be required to adhere to the Data Management and Sharing requirements as outlined in the NIH Grants Policy Statement (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/policy/nihgps/HTML5/section_8/8.2.3_sharing_research_resources.htm). Upon the approval of a Data Management and Sharing Plan, it is required for recipients to implement the plan as described.

4. Reporting

- When multiple years are involved, recipients will be required to submit the Research Performance Progress Report (RPPR) (//grants.nih.gov/grants/rppr/index.htm) annually and financial statements as required in the NIH Grants Policy Statement Section 8.4.1 Reporting (//grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82419). To learn more about post-award monitoring and reporting, see the NIH Grants & Funding website, see Post-Award Monitoring and Reporting (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=82428).

A final RPPR, invention statement, and the expenditure data portion of the Federal Financial Report are required for closeout of an award, as described in the NIH Grants Policy Statement Section 8.6 Closeout (https://grants.nih.gov/grants/policy/nihgps/HTML5/section_8/8.6_closeout.htm). NIH NOFOs outline intended research goals and objectives. Post award, NIH will review and measure performance based on the details and outcomes that are shared within the RPPR, as described at 2 CFR Part 200.301.

Section VII. Agency Contacts

We encourage inquiries concerning this funding opportunity and welcome the opportunity to answer questions from potential applicants.

Application Submission Contacts

eRA Service Desk (Questions regarding ASSIST, eRA Commons, application errors and warnings, documenting system problems that threaten submission by the due date, and post-submission issues)

Finding Help Online: https://www.era.nih.gov/need-help (https://www.era.nih.gov/need-help) (preferred method of contact)
Telephone: 301-402-7469 or 866-504-9552 (Toll Free)

General Grants Information (Questions regarding application instructions, application processes, and NIH grant resources)
Email: GrantsInfo@nih.gov (mailto:GrantsInfo@nih.gov) (preferred method of contact)
Telephone: 301-480-7075

Grants.gov Customer Support (Questions regarding Grants.gov registration and Workspace)
Contact Center Telephone: 800-518-4726
Email: support@grants.gov (mailto:support@grants.gov)

Scientific/Research Contact(s)

Richard T. Robinson, Ph.D.
National Institute of Allergy and Infectious Diseases (NIAID)
Telephone: 202-607-8565
Email: richard.robinson@nih.gov (mailto:richard.robinson@nih.gov)

Peer Review Contact(s)

Examine your eRA Commons account for review assignment and contact information (information appears two weeks after the submission due date).

Financial/Grants Management Contact(s)

Yescenia Mendoza
National Institute of Allergy and Infectious Diseases (NIAID)
Telephone: 240-627-3671
Email: yescenia.mendoza@nih.gov (mailto:yescenia.mendoza@nih.gov)

Section VIII. Other Information

Recently issued trans-NIH policy notices (//grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=11163) may affect your application submission. A full list of policy notices published by NIH is provided in the NIH Guide for Grants and Contracts (//grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=11164). All awards are subject to the terms and conditions, cost principles, and other considerations described in the NIH Grants Policy Statement (//grants.nih.gov/grants/guide/url_redirect.php?id=11120).

Authority and Regulations

Awards are made under the authorization of Sections 301 and 405 of the Public Health Service Act as amended (42 USC 241 and 284) and under Federal Regulations 42 CFR Part 52 and 2 CFR Part 200.

Weekly TOC for this Announcement (/grants/guide/WeeklyIndex.cfm?08-29-25)
NIH Funding Opportunities and Notices (/grants/guide/index.html)

NIH National Institutes of Health (/grants/oer.htm)
Office of Extramural Research
(https://www.hhs.gov/) Department of Health and Human Services (HHS)
USA.gov (https://www.usa.gov/)

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